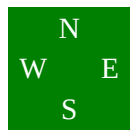


**Board 1**

North Deals  
None Vul

♠ 9 7  
♥ K 6 5 2  
♦ K Q 9  
♣ 10 7 4 2

♠ A K 6 3  
♥ A Q  
♦ A 10 7 5  
♣ A 8 3



♠ Q J 10 5 2  
♥ 8 4  
♦ J 8 3  
♣ Q 9 6

♠ 8 4  
♥ J 10 9 7 3  
♦ 6 4 2  
♣ K J 5

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 2NT   | Pass | 3♦    |
| Pass     | 3♥    | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

3NT by North

You don't have the entries to think about going over to dummy to finesse the ♥K, so you play the ♥A then the ♥Q, hoping a defender will grab their ♥K and set up three ♥ winners in dummy.

But they allow your ♥Q to hold the trick.

Now you are desperate. You need two entries to dummy, one so you can play ♥s to force out the ♥Q, and another to enjoy the good ♥s. One of these entries will be the ♣K and the second will have to be the ♣J. So you play a ♣ to the Jack and then you . . .

. . .

Lucky you. East held the ♣Q.

But don't get too smug. A lot of the plays work in these practice deals because they are set up to reward the correct Plan. In real life finesses only work half the time.

Partner's 3♦ bid is a transfer; you dutifully reply 3♥. Partner now bids 3NT.

Partner has just a 5-card ♥ suit. He doesn't have 4 ♠s or he would have used Stayman.

With no 8-card Major fit you pass 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♠Q on which West plays the ♠7.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 6

You might get one more winner from the ♣ finesse, but basically you are going to have to establish dummy's ♥s.

**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 4 2  
♥ A Q J 10 6 3  
♦ 5 4  
♣ 7 3

♠ K 9 8 3  
♥ 4  
♦ Q 9 6  
♣ K 9 8 6 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A J 5  
♥ 7 5  
♦ A K 7 3  
♣ A J 4 2

♠ Q 10 7  
♥ K 9 8 2  
♦ J 10 8 2  
♣ Q 10

| West             | North | East | South |
|------------------|-------|------|-------|
|                  |       | 1NT  | Pass  |
| 2♦               | Pass  | 2♥   | Pass  |
| 3♥               | Pass  | 4♥   |       |
| All Pass         |       |      |       |
| 4♥ by East hand. |       |      |       |

You have 9 points, an invitational strength hand. With 6 ♥s you transfer partner by bidding 2♦. Partner replies 2♥.

You have 9 points, an invitational strength hand. With 6 ♥s you transfer partner by bidding 2♦. Partner replies 2♥.

Remember, you have invitational strength, so even with a great trump suit you bid just 3♥. Partner puts it in game at 4♥.

The contract would be 4♥ played by West.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♦J and North plays the ♦9.

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 4 Losers are as seen from dummy, the long-trump

You might get lucky in one of the black suits, but your best hope is that South holds the ♥K.

You win the first ♦ and play a ♥ to dummy's ♥10, which wins the trick. You smile. Return to your hand with the other ♦, then play your last ♥ to dummy's ♥J, which wins the trick. But this time you don't smile because North discards! South still holds ♥K 9 and you have no more ♥s to lead for a finesse. Does that finish you?

Never say die. Return to your hand with a black Ace and ruff a ♦ in dummy. Dummy's trumps are now ♥A Q 6 and South still has ♥K 9.

Back to your hand with the other black Ace and ruff another ♦ in dummy. Dummy's trumps are now ♥A Q and South still has ♥K 9. Play any black card from dummy, then sit back and wait for your two trump tricks!

Bad trump splits can sometimes be countered by a technique called a trump coup.

The coup is accomplished by ruffing to shorten the trump holding so you won't have to play trumps from that holding.

Pretty much like this hand.